

OPPO Reno 8T

Undeniably stylish but lacks powerful hardware

The new OPPO Reno 8T priced at ₹29,999, competes against contenders from other companies such as iQOO, Poco, and Redmi. While it is a gorgeous-looking smartphone – features the slightly underwhelming Snapdragon 695 SoC. So, is the combination of design and camera enough to make up for the lacking hardware? Let's find out.

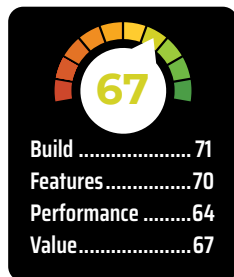
BUILD AND DISPLAY

The OPPO Reno 8T looks gorgeous and eye-catching with its matte-textured back with an iridescent glow. However, there is a considerable amount of flex on the polycarbonate rear panel. The buttons, on the side, are tactile and clicky and the frame of the phone is plastic but sports an aluminium look. The in-display fingerprint sensor is fast enough and we recorded only a couple of misreadings during our testing. The phone is also incredibly lightweight but also slightly slippery, so we suggest buying a good protective case. The Reno 8T houses a gorgeous curved panel that spills over the edges. Its peak brightness is rated at 950 nits, and we recorded 898 nits of peak brightness under direct sunlight, which nearly matches OPPO's claims. The viewing angles are also excellent. But sadly, the display is not HDR compliant, which is a big miss in this price segment. However, it is Widevine L1 certified, so you can view HD shows on streaming platforms.

PERFORMANCE

Starting off with benchmarks, the phone

₹29,999



expectedly scored underwhelmingly. In AnTuTu, the OPPO Reno 8T was considerably behind similarly or lower priced phones such as the iQOO Neo 7, POCO X5 Pro, and Redmi K50i. In GeekBench, the phone lagged behind the K50i and Neo 7, but beat the X5 Pro in the Single Core test surprisingly. Again, in PCMark-Work, the Reno 8T was left behind by all three smartphones. Moving on to GPU benchmarks, the phone lagged behind the Neo 7 and the K50i by a humongous margin in both the 3D Mark Wild Life and GFXBench benchmarks. In Gamebench Pro and the Reno 8T wasn't able to run Call of Duty: Mobile with consistent frame rates at High Graphics. So, we pushed the graphics down to Medium which is when the phone managed 57 fps gameplay at 97 per cent stability which is far behind the Poco X5 Pro. In day-to-day use, the OPPO Reno 8T manages to still feel responsive enough. OPPO's ColorOS 13 has a ton of customisations and features but there is a considerable amount of bloatware in the form of system and third-party apps. Overall, if you're looking for a performance-focussed phone, it is better to look elsewhere.

CAMERA

In terms of the cameras, in daylight, photos from the main camera look fantastic with vibrant albeit slightly saturated colours, impressive detail, and good dynamic range. The phone can extract a considerable amount of detail from the shadows without blowing out

the highlights too much, which is a plus point. Portrait photos come out looking social-media-worthy as well. In low light photography, the phone's camera struggles a bit with noise and softness creeping in along with a touch of lens flaring. The Reno 8T also adds a microscope camera that takes surprisingly usable shots. At first, we suspected this feature would be a gimmick but we were pleasantly surprised by how good the microscope shots looked. You can get in real close to subjects and extract some great looking, detailed close up shots like these examples we've added below. The 32 MP selfie camera impressed us with its colours, detail and dynamic range in daylight and low light.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life of the OPPO Reno 8T is more than satisfactory. The phone lasted over 15 hours in our 4K video loop test, which is fantastic at this price range. When the OPPO Reno 8T does run out of juice, the 67 W fast charging can speedily top up the phone from empty to full battery in merely 47 minutes, according to our tests.

VERDICT

The OPPO Reno 8T is undeniably eye-catching and has a good primary camera for daylight use and great battery life. However, it lacks powerful hardware. Lacklustre performance aside, the phone also could have better low-light photography, and it lacks essential features. Overall, the OPPO Reno 8T does feel like an overpriced device – where its looks are meant to be its saving grace – but sadly, we don't feel like its enough to get a confident recommendation from us.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 695 | GPU: Adreno 619 | OS: Android 13, ColorOS 13 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4x | Internal storage: 128 GB UFS 2.2 (expandable) | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED, 120 Hz, 1B colours | Cameras (rear): 108 MP main + 2 MP microscope + 2 MP depth | Front: 32 MP | Video: 1080p at 30 fps | Battery capacity: 4,800 mAh | Charging: 67 W SUPERVOOC | Colours: Sunrise Gold, Midnight Black

CONTACT

OPPO | Phone: 18001032777 | Email: NA | Website: <https://www.oppo.com/in/>